

BUSINESS TRAVEL POLICY

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Objective

This policy ensures that business travel undertaken by employees is consistent with the business objectives of HCL Technologies Ltd. It takes into account the needs of employees and the business, as well as our commitment to being an environmentally focused and sustainable organization.

This policy is also applicable to all employees active on the rolls of C2SIS.

Scope

The Business Travel Policy covers all aspects of international business travel (definition: outside your home country) and domestic travel (definition: within your home country), except travel within or originating out of countries such as Sweden, Finland, Czech Republic, Denmark, Poland, Germany and Norway where there is a separate policy.

Policy Details

Travel Plans (TP): Employees will be classified into different Travel Plans: TP1 to TP3 as per the table below:

Travel Plan	Employee Band
TP1	E6/E7/E8*/E9**
TP2	EM/E3/E4/E5
TP3	EC/E0/E1/E2

Travel in which all the segments are within the home country of the employee has been defined as Domestic Travel. Travel, where at least one segment of travel is outside the home country of the employee is defined as International Travel. Exceptions to this are: travel between and within US, Canada and Mexico; UK - Continental Europe; Singapore – Malaysia which would be treated as domestic travel.

Ticketing

HCL Travel Desk (Travel Desk) should be used to meet all ticketing needs. It is recommended that the following guidelines be adhered to for employees undertaking business travel:

- o This policy is meant to cover only Business travel. If the employee combines business travel with personal/holiday travel, then the employee is expected to segregate all bills (including lodging, boarding, conveyance, etc) and claim only the official expenses.
- o The travel requisition and approval process (as per Annexure A) must be completed in advance: 14 calendar days and 7 calendar days for international and domestic travel respectively. If the employee is unable to adhere to the above due to an unavoidable circumstance, he / she would be required to get an exception approval.
- o The Travel Desk will have the flexibility to book tickets within +/- 8 hours and +/- 2 hours for international and domestic travel respectively, subject to meeting the requirements of the latest arrival time for meetings, etc. at your destination.
- o Employees will travel by the most efficient and economical fare. The Central Travel Desk will organize the most cost-effective ticket, including the optimal route and there will be no choice with regard to selection of airlines. All tickets will be booked only with the employee's base location as the start point.
- o All domestic travel within India that takes less than 8 hours will have to be by train for employees who fall under the TP2 and TP3 plans.
*For all international travels with a duration of 8 hours and above, E8 band employees will be eligible to travel in Premium Economy.
**For all international travels with a duration of 8 hours and above, E9 band employees will be eligible to travel in Business class.

Lodging

- o It is advised that all lodging needs be routed through the Lodging Desk. The Company will book and make lodging arrangements for all employees through tie ups with vendors/properties. The employee is expected to settle all bills for their stay and claim reimbursement upon completion of their travel. Employee can avail an advance for their travel and settlement of these bills.
- o The Lodging Desk will try to book accommodation for employees within the defined limits as per Annexure (B), (C) and (D). In cases where employees wish to stay in a desired hotel whose rentals are more than the prescribed limits, exception Approval will be sought as per Annexure (A).

- o Employees are encouraged to use HCL preferred hotel chains. However, if employees would like to use client preferred hotel chains where the cost is lower than HCL preferred hotels, they will need to obtain explicit approval from the client prior to requesting the same with the lodging desk. If no duration is mentioned in the approval, the approval will be construed to be only a one time approval for immediate use only.
- o Service apartments / guest houses will be the preferred mode of stay.
- o Internet services and breakfast will be included wherever possible.
- o Lodging limits for all Travel Plans should be interpreted as upper cap on room tariff per night. This implies that rooms can be offered at lesser value than lodging limit as HCL has partnered with good quality hotel chains globally at attractive corporate prices.

Allowances: Boarding, Miscellaneous and Conveyance (BMC)

- o Daily Allowances Model: For employees travelling for less than thirty (30) days
- o Monthly Allowance Model: For employees travelling for, or in excess of thirty (30) days

Daily Allowance

The daily allowances provide flexibility to employees to manage their expenses across the expense heads of Boarding, Miscellaneous and Conveyance.

- o Employees have the option to claim reimbursements as “with bills”, “without bills” or through “own arrangements”.
- o Travels made for the purpose of attending Company sponsored events / conferences shall not be eligible for “ BMC without bills” . Thus, for such travels employees can only claim only under “ BMC with bills” or “own arrangement”
- o Own arrangement include all expenses such as Lodging, Boarding, Conveyance and Miscellaneous expenses. For Lodging expenses claim, employee must have overnight stay in Geo ,else employee shall be able to claim only the BMC with bills or without bills option.
- o For TP1 and TP2, the expense heads of Boarding and Miscellaneous are combined; and for TP3 all three expense heads of Boarding, Miscellaneous and Conveyance are combined.
- o For TP1 and TP2, in cases of claim “with bills”, if the upper cap for conveyance has been exceeded then the employee would have to seek his/her Reporting Manager’s approval at the time of settlement of allowances.
- o Entitlement of 100% allowances would be provided for days where the employee has spent more than 12 hours (midnight to midnight) at the host location. Entitlement of 50% allowances would be provided for days where the employee has spent less than 12 hours (midnight to midnight) at the host location. However, for the same day return trip (total travel less than 12 hours), entitlement of 100% allowances will be applicable, irrespective of the number of hours spent at the host location.
- o All the expenses incurred on laundry, house-keeping and other necessary jobs required for the stay can be claimed under boarding category by producing the bills for the same.
- o Entitlement amounts are in local currencies of the designated 100 countries in Annexure B and C.
- o No Exceptions would be allowed to Own arrangement and BMC without Bills option.

Monthly Allowance

- o For travel exceeding thirty (30) days, employees will have two entitlement options to choose from:
 - o With lodging support from the centralized Lodging Desk
 - o Without lodging support from the centralized Lodging Desk
- o For international and domestic travel outside India, if the expected duration of travel is more than one month, the monthly allowance would apply from Day 1 of reaching the destination city/host country.
- o The Employee must choose only one of the 2 options mentioned above while raising the TAS.
- o If the employee travels for less than a thirty (30) day duration, and subsequently extends his/her stay for more than thirty (30) days, due to official reasons, then the monthly allowance will become applicable from the day of the extension.
- o In cases where the employee has stayed in a particular location for more than thirty (30) days but has had to travel to another location for less than two (2) days because of official / personal reasons, the monthly allowances will be applicable.
- o The monthly allowance entitlement will be on calendar month basis i.e. irrespective of number of days in the month. For Example: Entitlement for the month of February (28/29 days) will be same as that of the month of March (31 days).
- o Travels to South Africa exceeding 30 days ,the Lodging limits(per night) shall not be guided as per this policy, please connect with the Local Admin team in South Africa for details on the same.

Other Allowances

Internet charges

For overseas travel a maximum allowance of USD 12 per day will be approved for cases where internet services are not complimentary with the lodging facilities (employees to submit confirmation from central lodging desk to claim the same). These expenses must be supported by bills from the hotel/internet café for reimbursement.

Provision for tips, portage and other non-bill expenses

When an employee selects the "with bills" option for any travel outside India, the policy would have a provision to claim USD 5 per day within the BMC limit. This provision aims to cover for expenses like portage, tips and other incidentals where bills are not available/obtained by the employee. For travel to/within India, the amount towards other appropriate charges will be INR 50 per day from within the BMC limit.

Group travel: lodging, boarding and miscellaneous

To handle group travel requirements undertaken for a bid, proposal preparation, presentation, or customer workshops, etc., the Lodging Desk will try to organize accommodation for all the group members in one property. This may involve upgrades of travel plan for some members in the group and would require only an approval from the cost center head of that group travel. Employees assigned to customer projects will not be eligible for this arrangement.

Several other allowances such as airport transfers, transit at airports, communication, rail transit allowance, etc are defined in the policy.

Approval Mechanism

There are two different approval processes.

- o The first one is the normal approval system, wherein all travel requests will be approved by the defined approvers.
- o An exception approval matrix is defined for cases where any deviation from the mandated policy guidelines is sought by an employee As per Annexure – A

Obtain authorization for travel expenses from the budget-holder before a commitment to spend is made. All travel expenses can be incurred only against approved budgets, and in case the approved budgets have been exhausted or are insufficient to cover a travel requirement, additional budgets would need to be sought before any travel can be allowed;

Country zone categorization

Based on the cost of living indices and our spend patterns, the countries which are frequented by employees have been categorized into seven zones: A to G, with each zone having similar entitlements for various daily allowances under heads such as Boarding, Conveyance and Miscellaneous. The seven country zone categories are:

A	Russia, Denmark, France, Italy, Monaco, Nigeria, Switzerland, Cameroon- Douala, UK, Japan – Tokyo and Osaka
B	Angola, Lebanon, Norway, Slovakia, Spain, Ukraine, Zambia, Finland, Germany, Netherlands, Republic Of Ireland , Macau
C	Canada, Romania, Turkey, USA ,Greece, Croatia, Brazil- Rio De Janerio and Sao Paulo, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Costa Rica, Poland, Belgium, Morocco, Saudi Arabia, Sweden, Venezuela-Caracas, Latvia, Austria, Australia, Japan – cities other than Tokyo and Osaka, Malta, Luxembourg
D	Hong Kong, Singapore, UAE, Argentina, Brazil-Porto Alegre, Chile, China, Cyprus, Ethiopia, Ghana, Hungary, Indonesia, Israel, Jordan, Kenya, Kuwait, Malawi, Oman, Qatar, South Korea, Tanzania, Vietnam, Estonia, Bahrain, Bulgaria-Sofia, Lithuania, Mexico, New Zealand, Honduras, Brunei, Botswana, Togo, Czech Republic, Egypt, Republic of Congo, Portugal, Thailand , Senegal, Lima, Mozambique, Guatemala, Khazakhstan
E	Brazil - Cities other than Rio De Janerio, Port Alegre and Sao Paulo, Malaysia, South Africa, Bulgaria, Colombia, Mali, Mauritius, Taiwan, Serbia, Bangladesh, Philippines, Zimbabwe, Dominican Republic, Nicaragua, Armenia
F	Algeria, Fiji Islands, Sri Lanka, Uganda, Venezuela- Cities other than Caracas, Bhutan, Nepal, Trinidad And Tobago, Rwanda
G	India

The allowances for each of the country zone categories and the countries within each zone have been defined in detail in Annexure B (Country Zone A to F) and Annexure C (Country Zone G: India).

Airport transfers

The charges for airport transfers can be claimed on actuals upon producing supporting bills.

Transit at airport

Employees on international travel who spend long durations of time at the airport because of transits or delays in flights will be entitled to a transit allowance for the time spent at the airport. This allowance can be claimed on actual up to a maximum of USD 25 per transit, after producing the relevant bills.

For the equivalent of the host country currency amount (for USD 25 per day) the calculation would be based on the average exchange rate for the employee's itinerary days in the host country.

Car rentals

HCLT has several corporate tie-ups with car-rental companies and employees availing car rental services must use cars from these designated companies. The details of all such car-rental arrangements are available with the Geo Administration teams. Car rentals and all expenses on car hire including expenses on flat tires should not exceed the local conveyance limits.

All travels using "Own Car" will be governed by the local conveyance and mileage policy.

Travel for official purposes to HCL Lucknow office using "Own car" is allowed and is governed by the local conveyance and mileage policy

Baggage/Excess baggage Allowance

In cases where free baggage is not allowed by airline, then employee can claim for 1 piece check-in baggage and in cases where any excess baggage is charged by the airline, such expenses may be claimed on actual subject to approvals by Reporting Manager(s), for carrying official goods only.

Foreign exchange/travel advances

- o The denomination of currency against which a travel advance will be issued is mentioned in Annexure B.

- o For travel less than a month, the allowance for the expected duration of stay will be given as travel advance together with a maximum buffer of USD 500 or its equivalent.
- o For travel greater than a month, the advance amount to the maximum of one month's eligibility will be issued
- o Employees are requested to use the company provided Travel/Forex card wherever applicable for all official expenses while on travel and all unused Forex to be returned to company as foreign currency only through the same vendor

Communication

Employees will also be reimbursed for expenses on account of official phone calls, faxes, photocopying, based on the approval of the L4 Head (RM in case L4 head or above is travelling). Employees are requested to get local connections for the purpose of calling while on international travel. No reimbursements will be made for international roaming connections both for voice and data and employees are advised to make arrangements accordingly.

Visa charges

Expenses towards any visa charges as applicable can be claimed on actual based on the approval of the respective RM and ISG representative.

Hardship allowance

The hardship allowance has been introduced for some countries, to take care of the challenging living conditions which may be found there. This allowance is paid over and above the current allowances and bills are not required to avail the claims. The details of the allowance limits are mentioned in Annexure B.

Examples of inappropriate charges

The following categories of expense will normally not be reimbursed:

- o Alcoholic drinks
- o In-room movies or PC games
- o Personal phone calls
- o The cost of professional journals and magazines
- o Replacement of an article of clothing, briefcase, etc., lost or damaged while on business travel
- o Purchase of an article of clothing in connection with assignment to a new location
- o Usage of fitness centers etc

The aforementioned examples are for illustrative purposes and cover only some of the inappropriate expenses that cannot be claimed. Common sense and good judgment are the best ground rules for comprehending this category.

Note: Exception approval matrix defined is applicable only for defined clauses and not for inclusion of clauses into the policy(please also refer process section of this policy)

Annexures are available in the forms section of the policy

Annexure A : Approval Matrix

Annexure B : Allowance entitlement Limits for Countries (except India)

Annexure C: Lodging Limits _Global _ City Wise

Annexure D : Travel Advance request Form

Annexure E : Allowance entitlement Limits for India

Disclaimer – The company reserves the right to alter, append or withdraw this policy either in part or in full based on management's discretion.